CASE STUDY: CPD PLATFORM

Building a Fully Integrated Continuing Professional Development Platform

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Timeline: 10–12 Months	**Focus Area:** Strategic Growth, EdTech & AI Pathways
Target Domain: Project Management & PMO Leadership	**Key Output:** Web App, LMS & OpenLearn Modules

1. Executive Summary & Core Intent

Continuing Professional Development (CPD) is a critical component of professional growth within Project Management. However, traditional implementations frequently suffer from passive execution—operating primarily as a 'tick-box exercise' for annual performance appraisals. Following an extended employment gap, this project was initiated to bridge the gap between traditional CPD tracking and strategic, data-driven career growth.

> **Strategic Vision:**
> *"By aligning activities, competencies, evidence, and career aspirations, the platform transforms CPD from a simple compliance exercise into a strategic, data-driven journey of growth."*

2. Identifying the Challenge & Industry Gap

Modern professionals face several friction points when navigating career development:

- **Fragmented Tools:** Existing logging tools consist of static templates or isolated frameworks (e.g., APM Competence Framework) that lack integrated execution mechanisms.
- **Unfocused Skill Building:** Without clear gap identification, professionals often complete random training modules that fail to address key competency deficits.
- **Low Engagement:** Standard tracking tools fail to maintain momentum, drive commitment, or provide actionable roadmaps toward aspirational roles.

3. Solution & Platform Architecture

To solve these structural challenges, a web-based platform was designed to integrate four foundational operational pillars:

Pillar / Module	Functional Capability & Role
Activity Logs	Records daily, weekly, and formal professional development activities with structured metadata.
Competency Frameworks	Maps activities directly against recognized industry competence frameworks (e.g., APM).
Evidence Tracking	Attaches tangible, results-focused evidence to demonstrate verified skill application.
Self-Assessment Engine	Evaluates current proficiency levels against target benchmarks to determine exact progression.

4. Advanced Intelligence & Ecosystem Expansion

Beyond functional tracking, the platform evolved to include intelligent analytical tools and integrated courseware:

- **Automated Gap Analysis:** Programmatically compares current proficiency ratings against target levels to identify immediate focus areas.
- **Dynamic Development Roadmaps:** Automatically generates actionable 3-, 6-, and 12-month development plans tailored to individual growth rates.
- **AI Career Simulator:** Utilizes live industry data and AI to project career progression from current roles to aspirational target roles, delivering custom recommendations.
- **Integrated LMS & OpenLearn Hosting:** Features dedicated course content including 'CPD for Modern Careers' and 'PMO Leadership', published on OpenLearn Create with digital badges and certificates.

5. Evaluation & Next Steps

Having completed pilot development and LMS integration, the platform is now undergoing peer review and testing. Current focus points include gathering structured user experience (UX) feedback from project management professionals and refining AI recommendation pathways to support diverse career trajectories.